QP: 25901577

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION March 2026

Fourth SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG4DSCVCN200 - ART & VISUAL PERCEPTION

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A

Short Answer

Answer any **5** questions

Each question carries **2** marks

1. Greek theatre is an ancient form of dramatic performance that originated in ancient Greece, especially in cities like Athens, as part of religious festivals dedicated to gods such as Dionysus.Use of **chorus** – a group of performers who comment on the action, provide background information, and interact with the main characters. **[K] / [CO2]**
2. The educational role of **Gothic art** was to visually teach religious stories and moral lessons to an illiterate population. **[A] / [CO4]**
3. M. F. Husain was a modern Indian artist known for painting, especially bold, expressive depictions of Indian culture and mythology. **[K] / [CO5]**
4. Sculpture in temple architecture serves decorative, symbolic, and religious purposes, illustrating deities, myths, and enhancing the spiritual and aesthetic experience. **[U] / [CO3]**
5. In Impressionism, light is treated as changing and dynamic, captured through quick brushstrokes to show its effects on color. **[U] / [CO5]**
6. In Renaissance painting, light and shade create depth, realism, and three-dimensional forms using techniques like chiaroscuro. **[U] / [CO4]**
7. A Sanskrit stage, based on the Natyashastra, is divided into acting area, backstage, and audience space with symbolic design. **[U] / [CO2]**

[2 x 5 = 10]

Part B

Answer in One Paragraph

Answer any **6** questions

Each question carries **5** marks

8. Art performs vital social functions by reflecting culture, shaping identity, and expressing collective values. It raises awareness about social issues, promotes unity, and preserves history. Art also challenges norms, inspires change, and encourages dialogue among communities, making it a powerful tool for communication, education, and social transformation in society. **[K] / [CO1]**.
9. Byzantine art is mainly religious in nature, focusing on Christian themes such as Christ, the Virgin Mary, and saints. It is characterized by the extensive use of colorful mosaics, gold backgrounds symbolizing divine light, and stylized, flat figures with frontal poses. The art emphasizes spirituality and inner expression rather than realism, and icons play an important role in worship and devotion**. [U] / [CO4]**
10. A Cubism artist would depict a still-life composition by breaking objects into geometric shapes and showing multiple viewpoints at once. Instead of realistic representation, forms are fragmented and rearranged on a flat surface. The artist uses muted colors, overlapping planes, and abstract structure to emphasize form and perspective over natural appearance. **[A] / [CO5]**
11. Buddhist art can be used in school teaching and learning to explain religious concepts, values, and history in a visual and engaging way. It helps students understand themes like peace, compassion, and mindfulness through images of the Buddha, stupas, and murals. It also supports cultural awareness, storytelling, and creative activities like drawing and interpretation**. [A] / [CO3]**
12. Persecution strongly influenced Early Christian art by forcing believers to express their faith secretly and symbolically. Artists avoided open representations of Christ, instead using simple signs like the fish (Ichthys), the Good Shepherd, and the anchor. Art was created in hidden places such as catacombs, focusing on hope, salvation, and eternal life rather than elaborate public display. **[A] / [CO3]**
13. In **Gothic churches**, architecture had a deep symbolic role, expressing spiritual ideas through design. Features like tall spires and pointed arches directed the eye upward, symbolizing the soul's ascent toward heaven. Stained glass windows filled interiors with divine light, representing God's presence. The overall verticality and grandeur conveyed the glory of God and inspired devotion among believers. **[U] / [CO1]**
14. To apply Cubism in a simple composition, choose basic objects like a bottle and fruit, then break them into geometric shapes such as cubes and triangles. Show multiple viewpoints at once, overlap forms, and flatten space. Use muted colors and rearrange parts to create an abstract, structured composition. **[A] / [CO4]**
15. Kerala Christian art shows a rich blending of local folk traditions with Christian themes. Indigenous elements such as temple-style architecture, oil lamps (nilavilakku), floral decorations, and mural-like painting styles are incorporated into churches and artworks. Biblical figures are sometimes depicted in local dress and settings, making the art culturally familiar. This fusion reflects adaptation, identity, and the integration of Christianity with Kerala's regional artistic heritage. **[A] / [CO3]**

(6 x 5 = 30)

Part C

Essay

Answer any **2** questions

Each question carries **15** marks

16. The transition from Baroque to Rococo represents a shift from dramatic intensity to refined elegance. Baroque art was characterized by grandeur, strong contrasts of light and shadow, emotional depth, and religious or political themes. In contrast, Rococo art embraced lightness, pastel colors, asymmetrical designs, and playful subjects like love and leisure. It moved away from heavy seriousness toward decorative beauty and intimacy, reflecting the tastes of the aristocracy and a more relaxed, pleasure-seeking society in 18th-century Europe. **[U] / [CO1]**

17. Greek theatre reflects the social, cultural, and religious life of ancient Greece in many ways. It originated as part of festivals dedicated to the god Dionysus, showing its strong religious roots. Socially, theatre brought citizens together, promoting unity and public participation. Culturally, it explored themes like fate, justice, and morality through myths and legends. Plays often addressed political issues, human behavior, and ethical dilemmas, making theatre a mirror of Greek society and its values. **[U] / [CO2]**

18. Early Christian art made extensive use of symbolism to communicate ideas of faith, especially during periods of persecution when open expression was risky. Simple symbols like the fish (Ichthys), the Good Shepherd, the dove, and the anchor conveyed meanings such as Christ, salvation, peace, and hope. These images were easily understood by believers but remained hidden to outsiders. The symbolic language helped teach religious concepts, strengthen community identity, and express spiritual beliefs in a subtle yet powerful way. **[A] / [CO4]**

19. Indian Schools of Art have played a crucial role in shaping and preserving Indian cultural identity. Institutions like the Bengal School of Art revived traditional styles and themes during colonial rule, promoting nationalism and pride in indigenous heritage. Artists drew inspiration from Indian history, mythology, and folk traditions instead of Western models. These schools encouraged cultural awareness, artistic innovation rooted in tradition, and helped establish a distinct Indian aesthetic that continues to influence modern art and national identity. **[U] / [CO3].**

[15 x 2 = 30]